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character of war has further undermined tank primacy. As the clash of mass armies in so-called conventional warfare has given way to smaller scale, more irregular warfare, tanks have lost their central role.

Tank formations nonetheless persist as important components of national armed forces everywhere. Further improvements in armor, weaponry, electronics, and general capabilities have continued, with remotely controlled unmanned vehicles high on many nations’ wish lists. A century after the tank’s 1916 battlefield debut, it remains a potent symbol of military power.

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